Biology Research Scientist (BA, MS, PhD's)

About the Role

Mercor is partnering with a leading AI research organization to verify protein target assignments in large-scale bioactivity databases (ChEMBL, BindingDB). You'll read primary literature, apply scientific judgment, and determine whether UniProt IDs accurately reflect the proteins being studied — work that directly feeds AI drug discovery pipelines.

What You'll Do

- Access primary sources (papers, patents) to verify protein target assignments against UniProt records
- Flag and classify target assignment errors using a structured taxonomy
- Propose correct UniProt accessions where assignments are wrong
- Write concise, evidence-grounded notes explaining your reasoning

Requirements

- BA/BS with 5+ years, MS with 2+ years, or PhD with industry or drug discovery research experience, in pharmacology, biochemistry, molecular biology, or chemical biology at a biotech, pharma, or CRO
- Hands-on binding or functional assay experience (SPR, TR-FRET, radioligand binding, kinase assays, GPCR functional assays, IC50/Ki/KD)
- Currently bench-active in a research, scientist, or associate scientist role
- Working fluency with UniProt or adjacent workflows: SAR support, HTS, target validation, biochemical profiling, or IND-enabling studies

Nice to Have

- Direct experience with ChEMBL, BindingDB, or PubChem
- Selectivity profiling or counterscreening experience
- Familiarity with agonist/antagonist vs. activator/inhibitor distinctions

Role Details

- 10–20 hrs/week | Remote | Immediate start
- 1–2 month minimum, extension likely
- U.S. only

We consider all qualified applicants without regard to legally protected characteristics and provide reasonable accommodations upon request.

Contract and Payment Terms

- You will be engaged as an independent contractor.
- This is a fully remote role that can be completed on your own schedule.
- Projects can be extended, shortened, or concluded early depending on needs and performance.
- Your work at Mercor will not involve access to confidential or proprietary information from any employer, client, or institution.
- Payments are weekly on Stripe or Wise based on services rendered.
- Please note: We are unable to support H1-B or STEM OPT candidates at this time.